

VISPORTFOLIO

VISUAL PORTFOLIO APP FOR MODERN ACADEMIC DOCUMENTATION

WHAT IS VISPORTFOLIO?



VisPortfolio is a sleek, web-based tool built to simplify and modernize how faculty manage and present academic records

- ✓ Store academic data
- ✓ Organize records into categories
- ✓ Generate resumes, CVs, and digital portfolios
- ✓ Use drag-and-drop tools to design tailored documents
- ✓ Eliminate redundancy and boost efficiency

WHY VISPORTFOLIO?

Designed specifically for faculty members, VisPortfolio saves time, reduces clutter, and empowers users to create professional academic documents with ease.



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Minh Huy Tran

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1. Features Implemented & Remaining

1.1. Implemented Features

Dashboard Functionality (Current UI):

- **User Authentication:** Signup/login via index page leading to dashboard.
- **Item creation:** Create, view, and edit academic items (e.g., publications, courses).
- **Document Builder:** Drag-and-drop interface for custom portfolio creation.
- **My Documents:** View and edit saved documents.
- **Task Tracking:** "To Do" section for administrative tasks.
- **Cover Letter Generator:** Automated cover letter with three templates
- **Form Progress Tracker:** Monitor status of active forms (e.g., tenure applications).

1.2. Remaining Features (Future Work)

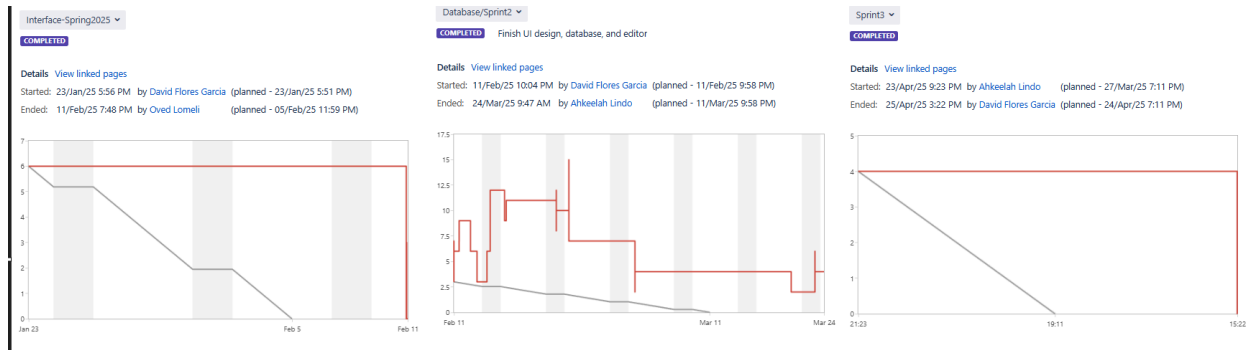
UI/UX Enhancements:

- **Angular Migration:** Convert static HTML/CSS/JS to Angular components for modularity.
- **Item Management Improvements:**
 - Stay on the "Create Item" screen after submission.
 - Display saved items on the same screen for easy editing/updating.
- **Design Consistency:**
 - Update green buttons to align with the website theme.
 - Ensure footer visibility on all pages.
 - Standardize navbar styling across views.
- **Drag-and-Drop Upgrades:**
 - Integrate a category UI drop container into document builder.

2. Known Issues

- **Angular Migration:** Some static HTML/JS files still exist outside the Angular component structure, reducing modularity and maintainability.
- **Inconsistent Button Styling:** Green buttons currently do not match the site's theme and need to be updated for design consistency.
- **Footer Visibility:** The footer is present, but often requires scrolling to be seen, especially on shorter or fullscreen views, making pages feel incomplete.
- **Navbar Styling:** Inconsistent styling across views breaks visual uniformity.
- **Drag-and-Drop Limitations:** Categories have not yet been integrated into the document builder for better organization.
- **Inline JavaScript:** Some JavaScript functions are written directly inside HTML files instead of being separated into dedicated JS files or Angular components, reducing clarity and reusability.
- **Format Button Glitch (Document Builder):** Clicking the "Format" button twice causes text to disappear from the left container.
- **Unexpected Redirect After Item Creation:** Submitting a new item redirects the user to the dashboard rather than confirming the entry on the same screen.

3. Velocity Chart Reflection



3.1. What Went Well

- Our team consistently completed sprint goals, as shown by the downward trends in all three velocity charts.
- We executed Sprint 3 efficiently, showing clear improvement in coordination and development speed.
- By Sprint 2 and 3, we had better-defined roles, which helped us stay focused and collaborate more effectively.
- We successfully implemented key UI components, including the homepage, drag-and-drop prototype, footer, and formatting tools.

3.2. What Could Be Improved

- In Sprint 2, some issues were either removed (e.g., VISON-21, VISON-29) or left incomplete (e.g., VISON-49), which impacted how our progress was reflected in the velocity chart.
- A few tasks were completed outside of their original sprint timeline, making our progress harder to track.
- The remaining in-progress task in Sprint 2 (VISON-49) was not completed because it became less relevant to the direction our project was taking.

3.3. What We Learned

- We learned that some tasks become outdated as our project evolves, so it's important to reassess priorities during sprint planning.
- Trying to handle Angular, backend integration, and database logic in one story (as in VISON-49) created unnecessary complexity. We now understand the importance of separating concerns early on.
- Removing or reassigning tasks during the sprint is sometimes necessary, but we need to document it clearly to keep the team aligned.

3.4. What We Would Do Differently

- We would spend more time refining the sprint backlog to avoid including tasks that are likely to be dropped later.
- We would label outdated or abandoned tasks as "Out of Scope" or "Deprecated" instead of leaving them in "To Do" or "In Progress."
- We would break large technical goals into smaller, clearly scoped tasks that are easier to estimate, assign, and complete within a sprint.

4. Project Flyer

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5. Screencast Demo

VisPortfolio Live Walkthrough: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SNDv9q67dM8>

Seamless Onboarding

- Quick signup/login process with immediate dashboard access

Intuitive Portfolio Building

- Live demonstration of drag-and-drop document customization
- Real-time preview of portfolio changes

Professional Output

- One-click PDF generation with formatting options
- Cover letter generator workflow

Efficient Management

- Create/edit academic items without page reloads
- Track form completion progress

6. Team Members

David Flores (Data Modeler & Team Manager)



Ahkeelah Lindo (UI Design & Client Liaison)



Oved Lomeli (Code Architecture/Lead Programmer & Testing Lead)



Minh Huy Tran (Code Architecture/Lead Programmer & Documentation Lead)



Dr. Anca Doloc-Mihu, the client for the VisPortfolio project

She wants a modern, web-based tool to replace outdated, manual processes for managing and organizing academic records. She needs a personalized dashboard to store and categorize her academic data, such as publications, certifications, and teaching history. The tool should allow her to easily create customized documents like resumes, CVs, and portfolios using drag-and-drop functionality, saving time and reducing repetitive work. Additionally, she

wants an intuitive and user-friendly interface that is easy to use, even without technical expertise.



7. Project Abstract

As part of our Software Development 2 class with Dr. Anca, our team Visionary has been developing the Visual Portfolio App following the MEAN methodology. This application aims to bring an easier way to create resumes, cover letters, and build your portfolio. The users will be able to select saved items which can be used to create new documents by simply using the drag and drop functionality. We also provide an appealing and user-friendly UI that will allow for a more efficient document creation experience.

8. Testing Coverage

Testing the API routes for the user registration and item creation connection to the MongoDB database. Download Postman API Testing platform.

Create a new request.

Change the request type to POST.

Enter in a URL:

(User Registration Testing)

`http://localhost:5001/api/users/register`

(Create Item Testing)

`http://localhost:5001/api/items/create-item`

Select Body, and then select the raw option.

Paste raw code:

(User Registration Testing)

```
{  
  "name" : "John Doe",  
  "email" : "johndoe@gmail.com",  
  "password" : "john123"  
}
```

(Create Item Testing)

```
{  
  "category" : "testing",  
  "itemTitle" : "testing item",  
  "itemDate" : "4/28/2025",  
  "itemDescription" : "This is a testing item using postman",  
  "userEmail" : "testingEmail@gmail.com"
```

```
}
```

Select Send and you should receive a success message.

The testing object you have entered will now be in their respective collection on the MongoDB database.

9. Documentation

9.1. Installation & Setup

Prerequisites: Node.js, MongoDB Atlas account

Backend Setup:

- 1. Clone repository:** `git clone https://github.com/GGC-SD/VisPortfolio.git`
- 2. Configure backend:**

```
cd VisPortfolio/backend
```

```
npm install
```

- 3. Create .env file:**

```
MONGO_URL="your-mongodb-atlas-connection-string"
```

```
PORT=5000
```

- 4. Start server:** `node server.js`

9.2. How to Run

- Open the File Explorer and navigate to the Visual Portfolio Project Files
- Go to `VisPortfolio/frontend/src`
- Open the `index.html` with preferred browser option

For full documentation:

[VisPortfolio README](#)

10. Usability Testing

During our usability testing, we observed five participants with varying levels of technological proficiency as they interacted with our application, and their feedback was valuable and shed light on some key areas for improvement. Starting with the home login/signup page, all the participants stated the view was very simplistic and easy to follow and understand. When given the task to create an account, there weren't any issues. Two of the participants explored the other navigation options on the first screen and questioned why there were options to view other pages like 'About', 'Explore', and 'Guide' but weren't being redirected to them. They were informed that those options were placeholders as of now, but will be implemented in future developments. One suggested there should be a 'Page Not Found' screen with the same colors and formatting that users should be redirected to while the options are still placeholders.

On the dashboard, the participants again noted the simplicity of the view and had no trouble interpreting the function of each card. All the users were told to create items they would put on a resume. None of them had issues figuring out which card to select to create their items. When creating the item, there was some confusion on what information the form was asking for them to enter. When explained what each section meant, they were able to fill out the form and create their items. One user messed up with their item and tried to use the update item button on the create items screen, but was informed that the update button was currently a placeholder. Another user stated they would like to be able to see the items they create on that page so they can keep track of all the items that have been created and update them if needed.

The participants were then directed to go to the document builder section where they can use the items they just created to generate a document. All the users were able to drag their items to the 'Document Builder' side, but pointed out after they selected the format button, there wasn't a document generated or built. It was just a list of all the item titles and descriptions. Most of them stated based on their understanding of the program, they expected this page to generate a full fledged and completed resume-like document.

On the cover letter page, all the participants liked the templates and having options to choose from. One user pointed out the breakdown of sections seemed unnecessary since it was all to be generated on the same document. They also stated the divided sections made it harder to view all the information from the templates. Some users did not like how the document was exported. They expected the document to look like the templates they chose, and there were poor responses to the view of the .txt file that was exported.

In summation, the users found the view and layout of the application to be clear and straight-forward. The main suggested improvements noted down were as follows:

- add a placeholder 'Page Not Found' screen for any navigation button that hasn't been implemented
- provide clearer instructions about what information to enter into the create items form
- allow the users to view and update their previously created items on the items page
- have the program generate a document for users to download after they use the document builder function
- remove the divided sections on the cover letter editing page for better view of all the information on the templates
- export the filled out cover letters to be formatted how they are shown in the example photos

11. Documentation Links

All resources are available in our GitHub repository:

[VisPortfolio/Documents/docs-Spring2025](#)

12. License & Intellectual Property Terms

12.1. License

This project is licensed under the [GNU General Public License \(GPL\)](#). You are free to use, modify, and distribute this software under the condition that any derivative works or modifications must also be made available under the same license, ensuring that others have the same freedoms to use and adapt the code. For more details, see [LICENSE.md](#) for details.

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12.2. IP

Intellectual Property Terms

1. The *Visual Portfolio* application, including its source code, design elements, UI/UX components, database structure, and documentation, is a collaborative work created by the individuals listed in the table below.
2. Each stakeholder agrees to the stated percentage of ownership based on contribution to the project.
3. Ownership percentages must total exactly 100%.
4. Any future modification, use, or distribution of the project outside of this context requires the consent of all stakeholders.
5. All stakeholders agree to and understand the terms outlined in this agreement.

Name (Typed)	Percent Ownership	Signature
David Flores	20%	___DF___
Ahkeelah Lindo	20%	___AL___
Oved Lomeli	20%	___OL___
Minh Huy Tran	20%	___MT___
Dr. Anca Doloc-Mihu	20%	___ADM___
TOTAL	100%	